

THE DAILY FINANCE BRIEF

Financial News in Plain English

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Personalised for Rishabh Srinivasan

MARKETS

Wall Street Ends Volatile Week Mixed as Interest Rates Rise and Oil Prices Worry Consumers

On September 18, 2026, the stock market, known as Wall Street, had a mixed week. The Dow Jones Industrial Average, which tracks 30 large U.S. companies, fell by 95.40 points, marking its worst week since March. Meanwhile, the S&P 500, an index that tracks 500 large U.S. companies, slightly increased, and the Nasdaq Composite, which focuses on technology stocks, also rose. This week, the interest rate for 10-year U.S. government bonds surpassed 5%, the highest level since 2007, raising

concerns about future increases in borrowing costs. Additionally, the price of crude oil, a key energy source, remained above \$100 per barrel, contributing to fears of rising costs for everyday goods.

For ordinary people, these developments mean that borrowing money, such as for mortgages or car loans, could become more expensive. Higher oil prices can also lead to increased costs for gas and everyday products, impacting household budgets.

Source: Business Today

MARKETS

Tech Stocks Boost Nasdaq While Interest Rates Climb and Cryptocurrency Surges

On September 19, 2026, the Nasdaq Composite, which focuses on technology companies, increased by 0.63%, driven by strong performances in tech stocks. However, the Dow Jones Industrial Average fell by 0.48%. The yield on 2-year U.S. government bonds reached its highest level since July 2024, indicating that investors expect further increases in interest rates from the Federal Reserve. In the cryptocurrency market, Bitcoin, a digital currency, surged by 4.49%, while Ethereum, another popular cryptocurrency, jumped by 5.80%. This indicates a significant rebound in the digital asset market.

For everyday people, the rise in tech stocks may signal opportunities for investment, while the climbing interest rates could affect borrowing costs. The surge in cryptocurrencies may also attract those looking to invest in alternative assets.

Source: Knightron Crypto

Central Banks Raise Interest Rates Globally to Combat Inflation

Central banks around the world are raising interest rates to address rising inflation, which is the general increase in prices. The Bank of Japan recently increased its target interest rate to 1.25%, the highest level in 31 years. Similarly, the U.S. Federal Reserve and the European Central Bank have also raised their rates. These coordinated actions aim to tackle global inflationary pressures, particularly due to rising oil prices.

For ordinary people, higher interest rates mean that borrowing money, such as for mortgages or personal loans, will become more expensive. This could lead to tighter budgets and reduced spending in the economy.

Source: Axios

New Review Questions Reasons Behind Silicon Valley Bank's Collapse

A new independent review challenges previous conclusions about the failure of Silicon Valley Bank (SVB) in 2023. The review suggests that rising interest rates devalued SVB's securities, which are financial assets that banks hold, making it vulnerable to a bank run, where many customers withdraw their money at once. Unlike earlier assessments, this review downplays the role of social media in the bank's downfall. The findings may have political implications, as they could be used to criticize the Federal Reserve's earlier conclusions about the bank's failure.

For ordinary people, understanding the reasons behind bank failures is important, as it can affect trust in the banking system and influence future regulations.

Source: Axios

COMPANIES

FCC Approves Major Merger Involving Paramount and Warner Bros. Discovery

The Federal Communications Commission (FCC) has approved Paramount's request for indirect foreign ownership in its proposed \$81 billion merger with Warner Bros. Discovery. This merger, which involves significant investments from foreign sovereign wealth funds, raises concerns about potential influence over media outlets. The merger is currently facing antitrust lawsuits, which are legal actions to prevent monopolies, from several states and the Writers Guild of America.

For ordinary people, this merger could impact the diversity of media content and the availability of news and entertainment options.

Source: Associated Press

Warren Buffett's Investment Philosophy: The Importance of Patience and Value

Warren Buffett, a renowned investor and former CEO of Berkshire Hathaway, is known for his investment philosophy that emphasizes patience and value. He believes in buying quality businesses at low prices and holding them for the long term. Despite the fast-paced nature of today's trading environment, Buffett's approach has led to significant financial success over the years.

For ordinary people, understanding Buffett's investment principles can provide valuable insights into making informed financial decisions and building wealth over time.

Source: Associated Press

Understanding the 'Innovation Exemption' in Financial Regulation

The 'Innovation Exemption' is a new regulatory provision from the U.S. Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC) that allows certain financial platforms to operate without some typical regulations for five years. This exemption is designed to encourage innovation in financial markets by providing a framework for trading new types of securities, which are financial instruments that hold value.

For ordinary people, this exemption could lead to new investment opportunities and changes in how financial markets operate, potentially affecting their investment choices.

Source: *Investing.com* PH

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